

The Holy Spirit Will Guide You Into All Truth

Thank You, Jesus.

All right, John 16. We will start around the fifth verse, where Jesus was telling them that He had to go away to send the Holy Spirit. We are going to kind of start in there and stay open, and I am going to progress toward something here. I want you to stay with me.

But now I go My way to Him that sent Me; and none of you asketh Me, Whither goest Thou?
But because I have said these things unto you, sorrow hath filled your heart.
Nevertheless I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send Him unto you.

One thing you can keep in mind here is that Jesus said, "It is expedient." That means it will expedite our cause, our overall cause, if I go away. It will be speeded up. In other words, it is absolutely necessary that I go away, and I know sorrow fills your heart.

But do you know that Jesus was going to be replaced by a greater Teacher than Himself?

You say, "Uh-oh."

See, Jesus taught your sense knowledge. He was teaching spiritually dead men. The reason He went away and came back, of course, was to die and make the rebirth available to you and me. We would be born again on the inside. Then we could be infilled and indwelt by the Holy Spirit, who can give us the insight that is imparted directly to our spirit.

I understand things in my spirit that even my head cannot figure out yet. When it does, I will let you know. That is called putting a revelation into words.

The Spirit Teaches Born-Again Men From the Inside Out

You are going to heaven. How many of you know you are going?

I mean, I know too. I am going. I am not going to trick you. He did not raise his hand until he let me finish the sentence, because last time I said, "How many of you are going to heaven?" everybody raised their hand.

I said, "What do you want to do that for? Heaven and earth is going to pass away, but His Word will abide forever."

The safe place is always standing on His Word, even when you get to heaven. Stand on His Word. It works.

He said that the natural man receives not the things of the Spirit of God, for they are spiritually discerned, spiritually understood, spiritually imparted.

It was necessary that Jesus went away, number one, to get us born in the image of God, a genetic rebirth by the Spirit of God, born from above, literally sired by the Spirit of God.

The second phase was to be indwelt by the Holy Spirit, where He could get on the inside of you and impart what we call revelation knowledge, an understanding of the mysteries of God, directly to your spirit and most of the time independent of your senses.

You hear the Word through your ears. You see the Word with your eyes. You see miracles work. But you cannot really conceive that until it is imparted and understood by your spirit. The things of God are spiritually discerned because the Spirit of God searches the deep things of God. The translation of that is: He searches the deep things of God and makes them known to you.

Praise God.

No wonder He said, "It is expedient," or absolutely necessary, that I go away. If He did not, the Holy Spirit could not come because there would be no price paid for sin.

All right. He went away.

The Comforter Convicts the World and Guides the Church

Now look at the job He said the Holy Spirit would do when He came back:

And when He is come, He will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment:

Of sin, because they believe not on Me;

Of righteousness, because I go to My Father, and ye see Me no more;

Of judgment, because the prince of this world is judged.

That word reprove means convince. He will convince the world of sin, righteousness, and judgment.

Then Jesus said with His own mouth in the twelfth verse:

I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now.

That means, "You cannot understand them now."

But now He is giving place to a Teacher who is going to teach you from the inside out. He said that anointing abides in you, and He was teaching along concerning them that seduce you.

Now, speaking from my own experience and on the scriptural standpoint, when I was first born again, I shoved everything in my mouth that sounded good. I know you have done the same thing as baby Christians.

Somebody would jump up and say, "If you fast eighty-one days, that is it. That is the whole thing."

So you run off and fast. You get real hungry, and you come back and say, "That was not all of it."

Somebody else comes along and says something else, and you do that because you are hungry, man, hungry for the things of God. Starvation in the spirit man causes you to act like that.

A little baby shoves anything in his mouth. But when he matures, he starts looking at what he shoves in his mouth. It is as simple as that.

In the beginning, I shoved about everything in my mouth that I could. But I was praying in the Spirit, and the Lord had me remember back in those days.

I remember when some old weirdo would come down the pike, jump on me, and say, "Hey, have you heard the latest? If you do not do this, you are not even saved."

At first I would get warnings. I would get red flags and inward knowings going off in me, waving flags that said, "No, no, no, no."

The guy would sound so overpowering and convincing that pretty soon I would say, "Well, it will not hurt to just try this." Then pretty soon my check would go away. The red flags would go down, and He would just let me wallow right on in.

But I cannot remember a single time I got myself into some kind of mess that I was not warned first. Then pretty soon the Holy Spirit will just settle down, and you will go your way. When you ask for help, He will step in and help.

He said concerning them that seduce you, in other words, you have an anointing in you that has been in there from the beginning, and it cannot lie. It is faithful. Every time somebody is trying to suck you off, seduce you, or get you wound up into a wrong doctrine, that anointing will warn you every time if you listen.

If you listen.

The Spirit of Truth Is a Guide, Not a Driver

Now look at the job of the Holy Spirit in the thirteenth verse:

Howbeit when He, the Spirit of truth, is come, He will guide you into all truth: for He shall not speak of Himself; but whatsoever He shall hear, that shall He speak: and He will show you things to come.

He shall glorify Me: for He shall receive of Mine, and shall show it unto you.

All things that the Father hath are Mine: therefore said I, that He shall take of Mine, and shall show it unto you.

Let this ring in your mind for a little while. When the Spirit of truth has come, the Holy Ghost, He will guide you.

Here is the guiding system. He will guide you.

Read this: "into all truth." With your pencils, underline that next word: all. Now say it out loud. How much of the truth? How much?

The Holy Spirit's job is to guide you into how much?

All truth.

In John 17, Jesus said, "Sanctify them," or separate them, "through Thy truth." Then He went on to say, "Thy Word is truth." What the Holy Spirit is going to guide you into is the truth of the Word of God.

This gets me excited because concerning the Word of God, Jesus said some things that it took me hours to get out of the chapter. He said, "The Spirit gives life." It makes alive. Then in the same breath, He compared it and said, "My words are spirit, and they are life."

The Holy Spirit takes these words. Jesus said, "My Word is spirit, and it is life." The Holy Spirit takes and guides you into the truth of the Word of God and translates it for you. He makes revelation out of it.

He says, "My words are truth, and they are life." Truth and life.

The Word Is Eternal Life Settled Before It Was Spoken

Whenever I open a chapter up to get what is in it, when God leads me to a chapter and I start meditating and praying, sometimes my hands actually tremble. I know that it is life in that chapter. I know it is eternal.

Speaking of the things of the Word of God, He says, "My Word abides forever. Heaven and earth will pass away."

Did you know that before Jesus ever opened His mouth and uttered one single Scripture, He says that the Holy Spirit got it from the Father, spoke it to Jesus, and Jesus spoke those words out? He says God gave not the Spirit by measure to Him because He spoke the words of God.

The Word says that it abides forever and ever. In other words, before God ever spoke out the Word you and I are getting, He meditated on it. God conceived it and meditated on it until it was settled even in His own heart, so that when He uttered these words out of His lips to be delivered to you and me, it was forever settled in heaven.

The revelation in that Word is forever settled. It will never, ever change or vary. It will always be absolutely the same. The truth in it is life and power, forever settled throughout eternity. Millions, trillions, billions of years, it will never vary or change.

That is why the life in it is life.

Now to think that I have that at my fingertips, to think that the revelation and understanding I get from the Holy Spirit concerning the Word of God has been forever settled throughout eternity, so powerful that before it was ever spoken, God knew it would never vary, not one iota, never, forever settled and always the same.

The reason God is the same yesterday, today, and forever is because when He opened His mouth and spoke His Word, His Word never changes. Therefore He does not.

When a person gets the revelation of the Holy Spirit concerning that which never changes, then if he really gives himself to it as the Bible says, lives in it, abides in it, lets His Word live in him, and he lives in Him, literally lives in the living Word and holds fast like a rock to that revelation that is settled from now throughout all ages, never ending...

When you get that revelation in there and say, "No, no, no. It is truth that I have received. I am on that Word. Therefore everything temporary must change, because His Word will not."

Your body is temporary. So are diseases. So is poverty. So is this earth. So is everything involved with it. It is temporary. But His Word is eternal, and it will never change. Neither will the truth the Holy Spirit reveals to your heart.

That is why, when a man really gets the revelation of the Word, it will change everything around him. Until it really becomes alive in you, believe me, it will change everything around you.

Meditating Begins With Excitement Over the Chapter's Eternal Truth

Now I am going to let you in on some secrets of meditating in the Word that God has shown me. It took me a while to get it, but I have an excitement in my spirit now.

In my office, I open my Bible, and a lot of times I will just read until a chapter is quickened to me. Then I will open it up and lay it on the table, and an excitement begins to come up in my spirit that I cannot even explain to you.

Do you know why? Because I know I am fixing to receive something eternal that will never change. I know the Greater One has gone off on the inside of me, and I know something is coming that will never vary: the eternal, settled Word of God.

I lay my Bible down, and I actually start shaking and kind of get half addicted over it. I lay my Bible down and start praying in the Spirit to shut myself down. I walk back and forth and make a pass by that Bible and read over it again. I make another pass and read it again, and another pass and read it again.

The excitement starts mounting because I already have a revelation that what I am going to receive is eternal, and I know what He imparts to me is going to work.

Now, with your pencils and a piece of paper, put point number one. Turn over to Luke 14.

How many of you have ever taught classes on the Word of God? Let me see your hands, real high please. You have literally taught a class somewhere and taught it in the Word of God.

Now another thing: how many of you have ever just flat taught somebody singularly? I mean, somebody gets a little turned on, and you just lay the Word on them. Let me see your hands. I know just about all of you have done that.

I am going to show you how God has shown me to get what I get out of these chapters. You know, I have come up with some dynamite off and on that just stood your hair right up on end.

People have come to me, and one guy came and said, "I do not see how you keep doing that."

I said, "Well, it is easy. It really is, because I have Somebody teaching me."

Never Build Doctrine on One Isolated Verse

When you are studying the Word of God, and this rule also applies when you are teaching the Word, rule number one is this: never just teach off of one Scripture.

If you are teaching the Word, never just teach it off one Scripture. If you do, you are running about a seventy-five percent chance of being in error.

Some of you notice that they say, "Roberson does not preach Scriptures. He preaches whole chapters."

You ought to thank God for that.

With that rule, put a side note, and always remember this: Jesus did not teach in chapter and verse. Neither did Paul, Peter, Matthew, Luke, or John. None of them taught in chapter and verse. They taught the chapter, the letter.

This is where we have gotten ourselves so messed up. When we itemized it and put it into Scriptures, it was so we could have a quick reference system. That is all it was designed to do. But we have taken a Scripture and made a god out of it. When we did, we got into error and made a whole lot of mistakes, because this was not taught in error.

The second rule is this: whenever you are working on a chapter, there is generally at least one and up to three, on average, major truths in that chapter.

Let us call it revelation knowledge, but do not let that scare you. Revelation knowledge is a fancy phrase for revealed knowledge. That means there is a main thought Jesus was trying to get over to you and me. It is in that chapter, and the Holy Spirit will bring it out for you in the form of revealed or revelation knowledge. That simply means it is a truth revealed by the Holy Spirit to you.

With the second notation, put this: there are generally between one and three spiritual truths in each chapter.

These are not in the form of just one single Scripture, but in the form of a whole truth. What Jesus endeavored to do was get the truth of the chapter over to you, not a single Scripture.

When the Holy Spirit goes to teach you what is in that chapter, He goes about it in the same direction as He did through Jesus and everybody who recorded it. He is after the truth in the whole chapter. He will not just try to expound on one single little Scripture in there, because that will get you messed up, and that is where most false doctrines come from.

Are you with me?

This is my second rule. I never take a Scripture, pick it out of the Bible, and stand on just that Scripture. I always take the revelation in the chapter and stand on that, then back it up with the Scripture.

I do not know if you can write all that or not. Just remember it. Get it down in your thinking and remember.

Remember the Revelation in a Chapter, Not Just the Verse Numbers

Somebody asked me this question, and I am going to explain it to you.

I got a memory book the other day, and it was on associations. In fact, it was called *The Memory Book*. I bought it once and forgot it in the airport.

When I got into these books, they dealt with association. You associate things to remember things, like a list of ten things you are going to shop for, and you associate them with something so you can remember the shopping list. Anyway, it is kind of funny.

The reason I did it was because my wife carries about thirty or forty telephone numbers around in her mind. Whenever I want to call somebody, I just say, "What is her number?" She flips it out there.

Finally I asked her, "How do you do that?"

She said, "I can just see it."

Well, I cannot. I have to ask her, and then I just got to depending on her like a telephone book. "Whose number is this?" She tells me. I have a phone in my car, so maybe I have to call the number in while I am driving along.

I say, "I am going to call so-and-so. What is her number?" She gives it to me.

I say, "I am going to call somebody else." She gives it to me. She only hears them once, and she can give them. She carries about thirty of them around in her mind.

So I thought, Man, I am going to have to do something about this. I bought myself a memory book. I am going to challenge that.

When I got into it, I found out that he was explaining the same principles I had been using to remember what is in the Word of God all the time.

Somebody asked me, "How do you know what is in each chapter? How do you know the Scriptures and verses that are in these chapters? How do you get it?"

I do not. I do not try to remember Scriptures and verses in the chapters.

Do you know what I can recall right now? I have preached as high as forty times in one month, driven three or four thousand miles, and preached night after night up to two hours, and I have never lifted a pencil with a note. Not one single note.

People begin talking about a chapter, and I can tell them what is in the chapter. I cannot always tell them verse for verse, but I can tell the revelation in the chapter.

The reason I can is because I went into it. I moved into that chapter one time or another. I lived there. I lived in it day and night and digested it until it literally became part of me, and I became part of it, to the point that I was there. I walked with Jesus. I was with Him when the whole thing took place.

I know what He did. I know what is in that chapter. I know the truth in it and what He is trying to bring out, instead of just trying to memorize isolated Scriptures and verses.

When He says the Holy Spirit has come to lead you into all truth, He is authorized to lead you into the chapters, to lead you and get the truth that was recorded in there, the truth all these Scriptures collectively brought to you.

Meditation Reads the Whole Chapter Until the Collective Thought Forms

Now I am going to show you the technique in Luke 14, because I had a hard time breaking this chapter at one time. I am going to show you how to meditate in the Word to get the collective thought, to get the revelation that is in it, instead of just picking a single Scripture and saying, "Well, I wonder what that means."

Have you ever heard preachers preach on this Scripture?

If ye abide in Me, and My words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.

I have picked that one out lots of times and yelled it at everybody: "Man, you need to abide in Him and Him in you." I was real strong on it, which is true.

But do you know what that was? That was the end of a teaching that showed you how to be purged. At the end of that teaching, when you have purged everything else out and there is nothing but the Word left living in you, and you in Him, then, then, then you can ask what you will and it is done.

It is nice to throw that out there and just say, "Well, everybody, He lives in you and you live in Him." Everybody admires that and says, "Oh, goodness, is that not neat?"

Yes, it is neat all right, but how do you get there? He just detailed how to arrive at that place.

This is a hard chapter here. The way I begin getting what is out of a chapter is I take it from the beginning and read through the whole chapter at least six or seven times, even up to thirty times.

The reason I do that is because I am allowing the Holy Spirit to get the drift of the whole thing over to my spirit. What is the collective thing God is trying to get to me out of that chapter? The whole thing, not a single Scripture, the whole chapter.

I will read it at least six or seven times, even up to thirty. I have prayed five and six hours straight in the Holy Spirit and read a chapter forty or fifty times.

Then in my spirit, at least two highlights of that chapter will begin to form. When I say highlights, I mean two total thoughts that Jesus, Paul, or Peter taught on. Usually these two total thoughts are linked together by a lesser revelation of some kind.

I am going to show you here. I read over this chapter, and then the Holy Spirit was teaching me these things. He had to literally tell me to back up in this chapter. He told me to do that, and I backed up in it. When I backed up in it and read, I understood for the first time how to get revelation real strong out of a chapter.

What was the Holy Spirit sent to do? Guide you into all truth. He is your Teacher here now.

Luke 14's Hard Saying Opens Only When the Supper Parable Is Kept With It

Let us begin here. Why do we not look at the twenty-sixth verse? I have not seen very many preachers who even want to touch it. I am going to pick this one out of the middle to confuse you, because I have heard preachers preach on this, and it was sick.

Look what He says in Luke 14:26:

If any man come to Me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be My disciple.

Boy, do you realize what that did to some submission doctrines? When you have, "Wives, submit to your husbands," and all that? Goodness. We have a direct contradiction there somewhere.

He says, "If any man come to Me, and hate not his father and mother and wife..." Well, goodness, that could throw a guy for a curve, could it not?

So I read that, and to be honest with you, I meditated on that for probably a good hour.

I will show you something. This is how I meditate now. I shut my sense man down. I do not know if you know how to do that yet, but that is what these Monday night meetings are for, to teach.

When I get a Scripture out like this, I shut everything down on the outside. I have learned to do that when I am ministering to you. You see me get a weird look on my face, and all of a sudden some of you have told me, "It looks like you are looking right through me."

Basically, I am. A lot of times your mouth is moving, but I have learned to shut myself down so well that I can see your mouth moving, and if you are talking a big, long problem, I lose you. I do not even hear you. I can see your mouth going, and I am listening to God.

I have already shut down. I shut my ears and eyes down. You could walk up behind me and say, "Dave," and I might not even turn around. Why? I shut my receivers down from the outside because I have made up my mind that I am going to receive from the inside.

I am not disturbed. I have gotten where I can do that in the subway, if we had one here, with trains running by. I do not care what kind of noise is there. I can shut down anywhere now.

When I say that, I mean I can flick a switch on the inside of me where I learn to listen to my spirit. I open him up for the Holy Spirit to say anything He wants to, because I am not influenced by what I am seeing, hearing, or any outside influence. I have literally shut down.

That is what I did to this Scripture. I read it with my eyes. I heard it with my ears. Then I literally shut down, transfixed myself on it, searched my spirit, and turned it loose to the Holy Spirit so that if there was anything in there He wanted me to have, He would enlighten me to it.

When I did that, I began to see inklings in me. I read over it several times, and the thing that kept sticking out to me was, "his own life also." That kept going in my spirit: "his own life also, his own life also, his own life also."

Then I knew He was talking about something concerning salvation. He was not talking about literally hating your wife and all that. That was a comparative sense. Later, when I broke the Greek down on it, I found out I was right.

I read that three or four times, and then He had me back up to the twenty-fifth verse. I backed up one verse above it:

And there went great multitudes with Him: and He turned, and said unto them...

About that time, the Holy Spirit asked me this, and you will find He teaches you by asking if you will learn to listen. He asked me, and I remember it very clearly because He was teaching me how to meditate:

"Who do you think that multitude was? Who do you think it was?"

I did not know. So at that time He told me to go to the beginning of the chapter. This is where God taught me a valuable lesson: there is truth in the Word of God, and we are after the truth, not the single Scripture, because you can make doctrines that cause people to fall.

He had me back up. Let me show you who the multitude was that went with Him.

Beginning with verse 15:

And when one of them that sat at meat with Him heard these things, he said unto Him, Blessed is he that shall eat bread in the kingdom of God.

Then said He unto him, A certain man made a great supper, and bade many:

And sent his servant at supper time to say to them that were bidden, Come; for all things are now ready.

And they all with one consent began to make excuse.

The first said, "I have bought a piece of ground. I must needs go and prove it. I pray thee have me excused."

Another said, "I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I go to prove them. I pray thee have me excused."

Another said, "I have married a wife, and therefore I cannot come."

So the servant came and showed his lord these things. The master of the house, being angry, said to his servant:

Go out quickly into the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in hither the poor, and the maimed, and the halt, and the blind.

The servant said, "Lord, it is done as thou hast commanded, and yet there is room."

The lord said unto the servant:

Go out into the highways and hedges, and compel them to come in, that my house may be filled.

For I say unto you, That none of those men which were bidden shall taste of my supper.

There is your halls, just like you are in: "Compel them to come in, that My house may be full."

Then, here is what threw me for a long time. My King James has a change of subject right here. See? It did not know any more than I did.

Now, those guys were good translators. They did an excellent job. This is my favorite Bible. But I will say this: their wording and phrases are different than a lot of our wording and phrases today.

Have you ever read through the Word, read something, and it did not make sense? You say, "That just does not seem to tie in." Do you know what is going on? Something in your spirit.

If you will go get the Greek and all that out and break it down, you will find out that generally it agrees with the anointing that lives in you. The King James just missed something somewhere and said something that throws a different image than it should have thrown in us. It does not agree with the Holy Spirit, and you get a reaction. You go, "Hmm. How come that does not make sense?"

I know there is one I am working on now. It says that He was born not of the flesh, nor the will of man, nor of blood, but of God. There is one in there that I thought was speaking of us, but I found out it was talking about Jesus not being born of the will of man, but of God.

That never did check in my spirit, but the Greek said it was talking about Jesus. He was not born of the will of man; He was born of God. That had gone off in my spirit for a long time the wrong direction.

So when I got into this chapter, I said, "Lord, You are still on the same subject, and this twenty-sixth verse ties back to what we just got through reading." These revelations were beginning to form, but I still had to get them out.

Then it dawned on me, and I thought I was so smart because all of a sudden I knew who that crowd was that He turned on.

Look at verse 25 again:

And there went great multitudes with Him: and He turned, and said unto them...

He turned on them and said:

If any man come to Me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children...

Did you know He just named the things those men rejected salvation over? One said, "I just married a wife." Another said, "I just bought some land and have to go look at it." Another said, "I just bought some oxen."

They rejected it. I knew then by revelation that the supper they were bidden to was a salvation call to the world, because He said to go into the highways, byways, and hedges. It was a salvation call to come to the table of God, get born again, get healed, get salvation, and get everything.

So He turned on the crowd He had just preached to, because they were the ones rejecting. He said, "If you come to Me and have to choose, and you choose oxen, wives, and land, then you are not worthy of Me."

That is one main revelation in that now. One main revelation.

Choosing Christ Over Every Competing Claim Is the First Revelation in Luke 14

Are you learning?

Praise God. The Holy Spirit, believe me, you are a faithful bunch and you want to know these things. We can teach you a whole lot, but there is only so much we can teach you. There comes a time when you can open a chapter like this and get it yourself. That is when the Word of God just comes so alive.

When I saw that He turned on that bunch, and believe me, when Jesus preached to that bunch about yoke of oxen, there were people there who would not accept salvation because of monetary goods or anything else you can name.

Then He says, "You are not worthy of Me." He said to hate your own life also. In other words, if you reject salvation, are your oxen going to save you? Is your wife going to save you? Is your land going to save you?

What kind of price are you putting on this thing?

When He said, "You are not worthy of Me," that was an understatement. Where are you going to go? What else are you going to do? Live your fifty or sixty measly, troubled years out on this earth, then die and go to hell? What kind of deal is He offering you?

No wonder He said, "You are not worthy of Me."

That excited me because the word hate is a comparative word, meaning that if you are forced to make a decision, then, brother, you had better choose Him, because your wife or nothing else can save you. You are not called to go to hell over anybody or anything.

Boy, this is getting exciting. I am getting addicted, and I have already been over this.

Hallelujah.

I spend most of my time listening to God. It is my favorite sport. Oh, thank You, Jesus.

Sometimes I will drive miles and miles and not realize I did it, meditating. I will get Scriptures inside of me and just roll them and roll them and roll them, then listen to the Holy Spirit and shut down. Listen.

Then I will get an inkling, and a formation of revealed knowledge will start coming. It will build in me, and one Scripture after another will build, and pretty soon it will burst into full light. When it does, that is when I come out here and say, "Boy, you have had it."

The other day, when I was meditating through loosening and binding, all of a sudden old Peter said, "How many times do we have to forgive this guy?" I realized He said, "Loose him." In the next chapter, God was loosening and forgiving.

I realized He was talking about when you pray and bind: if that guy is going to be a heathen to you, bind the devil and loose the man. If you have to, do it four hundred ninety times a day, and it will cause your faith to work.

My God, I had never even heard anything like that on tape.

All right, His ability to teach you and me.

The Cross Is the Chosen Path of the Love Walk, Not Affliction

Let us go after the second part of this revelation.

He turned on that crowd. He made a statement:

If any man come to Me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be My disciple.
And whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after Me, cannot be My disciple.

Disciple means disciplined follower.

A lot of us have had a misconception of the cross. Some of us are sick, broke, afflicted, or even bound to a wheelchair, and you hear this so much in the humility group. You can understand their reasoning. They say, "Well, this wheelchair is just my cross."

Have you ever heard that?

Somebody gets beat up or gets in a car wreck and is crippled the rest of his life, and he says, "This is the cross God has laid on me to bear."

It is not so.

Do you know what the cross is? I will tell you exactly what it is. It is the narrow path. Do you know what the narrow path is? It is the love walk. That is the cross God has laid on you: the love walk.

Let me prove it to you:

Whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after Me, cannot be My disciple.

Did you notice that it is your choice to bear that cross? Whose choice is it? You pick your cross up, or you lay it down.

Now let us see any of you lay a wheelchair down. It was not your choice to get in one, and it is not your choice to get out. You cannot lay that down on your own will. You can lay it down through prayer and the prayer of faith, yes. But if it is a cross you picked up, then it is a cross you can lay down.

You certainly cannot lay down a wheelchair and a broken body unless you have the Word. Can you see the deception in that?

Did you notice there He said you cannot be My disciple? In other words, if your wife is fighting you, and the land and all that stuff is pulling on you, then you have to pick up your cross and make a decision to follow Him, or you cannot be His disciple.

A disciple is a disciplined follower. Jesus says:

Why call ye Me, Lord, Lord, and do not the things which I say?

If you do not do His Word, He is not over your all. "Lord" means over all. Boy, when He said Lord, He did not say it once. He said, "Lord, Lord," twice in worship. "Why do you call Me Lord, Lord, and do not the things which I say?"

I thought that when Jesus was talking about me having to choose between Him and everything else, because my wife cannot save me, my land cannot save me, and my oxen cannot save me, He was being hard on me. I thought He was demanding total sacrifice, until I got into the rest of the Scriptures.

Now we are coming up on revelation number two.

Counting the Cost Means Forsaking Everything That Cannot Finish the Tower

In the course of reading through this chapter several times, I ended up at the end of it, on the thirty-third verse, and a bell went off in my spirit that brought me back to the first half. I knew Jesus was still talking about the same thing.

As far as I was concerned, He changed the subject when He started talking about towers and building. But He did not.

Look at verse 33 with me, and listen to your spirit:

So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be My disciple.

Did you notice He did not change the subject? Does that agree with your spirit?

Now we are after another revelation. He threw clear back to the twenty-sixth verse in this one. That means everything between here and verse 33 is the "likewise" He is comparing us to. Revelation number two must be right in there.

Now look at verse 34:

Salt is good: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be seasoned?
It is neither fit for the land, nor yet for the dunghill; but men cast it out. He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.

He is talking about the ears I am telling you to listen with tonight. He is talking about the ears you could have used to go ahead and get the rest of this. That is why He says, "He that hath ears to hear, let him hear."

I said, "Lord, I am going to hear. I am going to hear with my inner man."

Right here in verse 34, there was a part of this that broke this whole chapter open for me.

He said, "Salt is good, but if salt has lost its flavor, wherewith shall it be seasoned?" What is He saying here?

Take a handful of salt. Take the flavor out of it. Now where are you going to go to get something that can season it to make it taste like salt again? There is nothing. There is no substitute you can get to season salt back up and make it taste like salt.

With that in mind, throw back to verse 26:

If any man come to Me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children... and his own life also, he cannot be My disciple.

In other words, if you reject Him over land, houses, or anything else, then where are you going to go to get seasoned? Where are you going to go? What are you going to turn to?

Now we are ready for the next verse:

For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it?
Lest haply, after he hath laid the foundation, and is not able to finish it, all that behold it begin to mock him,
Saying, This man began to build, and was not able to finish.

Notice He is asking a question here. You have to realize I went over this and over it and listened to my spirit.

He is saying, "Which of you intending to build a tower will not sit down first and count the cost?"

I am asking you the same question Jesus did. How many of you would build a house, start building it in the middle of the summer, and only have enough money to finish everything but the roof, knowing it would rain?

How many of you are dumb enough to do that?

I am not talking about faith. If you give me a nail, I will tell somebody, "I will put a house on it." There was a bum going around with a button, handing it to people and saying, "Would you sew a shirt on it?"

I am not talking about faith people, because I know, give me a nail and we will put a house on it. I am saying He was speaking strictly in a natural sense.

Is there any of you dumb enough to sit down with half enough material, knowing you only have half enough to finish a house? None of us, really.

Let us say I owned a construction company, and I was building a six-million-dollar complex. There was a company watching me that was going to give me a job worth thirty million dollars. What if I started building, then all of a sudden I ran out of funds, and there it sat by the freeway?

Do you think that other company would give me their job? They would not, because I was too stupid to count the cost and see if I had enough to finish it.

He is asking you this: which of you is that dumb? Literally, none of you.

Then He says:

Or what king, going to make war against another king, sitteth not down first, and consulteth whether he be able with ten thousand to meet him that cometh against him with twenty thousand?

Or else, while the other is yet a great way off, he sendeth an ambassage, and desireth conditions of peace.

He is asking you, "Which of you would go after twenty thousand with ten thousand?" Just answer directly. How many of you would do that? How many would build a house without enough to finish?

In the natural, none of you.

Now you know who the "likewise" is in the next Scripture.

So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be My disciple.

Who is the likewise? He is saying you are like somebody. Who are you like? The person too dumb to count the cost to build a whole building, and the king too dumb to sit down and find out whether he can whip twenty thousand with ten thousand.

He said you are like these dumb people who build a house with no foundation and never complete the job. That is how dumb you literally are. I have got to get this over to you. That is how dumb you are.

In other words, He is putting you in exactly the same boat with the man who did not have enough materials to finish that tower if you do not forsake all that you have to become His disciple. If you do not, you are the guy who fails. You are a half-a-tower builder if you do not sell out to His Word.

Can you see that now? That is the second revelation in this. You fail if you do not. It looks like you are failing if you do.

You say, "I have to choose Jesus over my wife and everything else?"

Yes. You will lose her if you do not.

"You mean I have to choose between Him and oxen and land and houses?"

You will lose them if you do not.

So likewise, whosoever, and that covers you and me, whoever does not forsake all that he has cannot be His disciple. In other words, you are dumb, and you only have half enough to finish anything you start unless you found it on the Word.

Continuing in the Word Is What Makes a Disciple Finish and Win

Did you notice He said, "Cannot be My disciple"?

Disciple means disciplined follower. The word disciple is derived from the word discipline.

Concerning that, Jesus says:

If ye continue in My word, then are ye My disciples indeed;
And ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.

There is only one Scripture that tells you what makes you a disciple. He said, "Why do you call Me Lord and do not what I say?" If you are not doing what He says, you are not His disciple. You might be born again, but you are not His disciple.

He says unless you continue in My Word, when you continue in it, build a tower founded on the Word, and continue in it, then you are My disciples indeed, meaning in your deeds, and you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.

In other words, your tower will always finish, and you will always win your wars. He says likewise, if you do not forsake, you are as dumb as the guy who had half enough material.

There is only one way you will become His disciple. One way: continue in His Word.

So basically what He is saying here is, "Likewise, whosoever of you does not forsake all that he has for the Word, sell out to the Word, follow it, and continue in it, cannot be My disciple."

Now you say, "I know preachers, lots of them, who have big churches. Everybody is coming, and they look like they are doing real good to me. They are making it."

Yes, dying in their bodies. A lot of them are depressed, sick, and using excuses for why the Word does not work instead of why it does. And you call their house built on a rock?

There were two major revelations in that. Could you see them? The two connected. They tied in with one another. There was the salvation call, the selling out to it, and the consequences for the man who does not do it.

Thank You, Jesus.